

United States Senate

WASHINGTON, DC 20510-4705

February 3, 2026

Her Excellency Ambassador Kyung-wha Kang
Embassy of the Republic of Korea
2450 Massachusetts Avenue, NW
Washington, D.C. 20008

Dear Ambassador Kyung-wha Kang:

I am writing to express my grave concern regarding the Korean Government's unfair targeting of a Washington state-based company with significant operations in Korea. Coupang is a Seattle-headquartered digital retail and technology company that exports billions of dollars of U.S. agricultural products, consumer goods, and services to Korea annually and supports thousands of jobs in the State of Washington and across the United States. Since last year, the Korean Government has subjected Coupang to a series of investigations, regulatory burdens, office raids, and fines that have been alleged in a filing before the U.S. government to be far more frequent and severe than those imposed on its Korean industry peers.

A recent petition for relief filed before the Office of the U.S. Trade Representative asserts that the company has been unfairly targeted, and that the "Korean Government has used a limited data breach in November 2025 as a pretext for launching a whole-of-government pressure campaign, unjustifiably and arbitrarily singling out Coupang for discriminatory treatment and disproportionate treatment." As described in the petition, senior officials have publicly called for penalties and sanctions that seem explicitly designed to force Coupang out of business, including fines large enough to cause the company's collapse and other punitive sanctions such as revoking delivery business licenses, conducting intensive tax audits, and even considering suspension of Coupang's business operations and requiring divestment of its affiliates, while pressuring public pension funds to divest and exclude Coupang from future portfolio allocations. In parallel, hundreds of government investigators drawn from multiple agencies have been deployed against the company, creating an ongoing physical and disruptive presence at Coupang's Seoul headquarters.

These actions and statements appear to be a deliberate strategy to weaken a U.S. company through punitive actions while simultaneously enhancing the competitiveness of domestic rivals through deregulation and state support. Given the strong alliance between the United States and Korea, and the strong and mutually beneficial relationship between Korea and the State of Washington in particular, I urge your government to end calls for company-specific laws, punitive sanctions, the targeting of American executives and its citizens, or other pressure tactics seemingly designed to eliminate a U.S. firm to favor domestic competitors.

I hope these issues will be addressed swiftly to avoid further threatening and undermining our crucial economic and security alliance grounded in the principles of mutual respect, non-discrimination, and the rule of law.

Sincerely,



Maria Cantwell
United States Senator